HR-206 Remote and Hybrid Working

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Effective Date: 1 January 2026 Owner: People Operations
Applies to: All permanent and fixed-term employees

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1 Purpose and Scope

This policy sets out the company's approach to working from home and to hybrid and remote working arrangements. It explains who may work remotely, how arrangements are agreed, and what the company provides.

It covers the regular pattern of where work is done. A one-off day at home for a delivery or an appointment is agreed with the manager and needs no application.

2 Definitions

Hybrid working means a regular pattern in which an employee works part of the week from a company office and part from home.

Fully remote working means an arrangement in which an employee has no regular requirement to attend an office.

The contractual place of work remains the office named in the contract of employment unless a fully remote arrangement has been formally agreed.

3 Eligibility

Hybrid working is available to employees in roles that do not require daily physical presence. The manager determines whether a role requires presence, and records the reason where it does.

Employees in their first eight weeks normally attend the office daily, so that onboarding is not conducted at a distance.

Fully remote arrangements are discretionary and require the approval of an HR business partner. They are not granted on request.

4 Working Arrangements

4.1 Team Working Agreement

Each team publishes a working agreement stating which days the team is in the office together, the hours during which members are expected to be contactable, and how meetings are run when some attendees are remote.

The working agreement is reviewed every six months. An employee who cannot meet it raises that with their manager rather than quietly departing from it.

4.2 Working from Home and Remote Work Arrangements

Employees eligible for hybrid working may work from home for up to two days each week, subject to the team working agreement. The days are agreed with the manager and are normally fixed rather than varied week to week.

A fully remote arrangement may be agreed where the role allows it, the employee has a suitable working environment, and the manager is satisfied the arrangement will not affect the team. Fully remote arrangements are reviewed every six months.

Where a fully remote arrangement is withdrawn, the company gives at least eight weeks' notice, and the employee returns to the pattern set out in the team working agreement. The reason for withdrawal is given in writing.

4.3 Working from Another Country

Working from another country requires approval from an HR business partner before any travel is booked. Tax, social security and right-to-work obligations differ by country and are assessed case by case.

Approval for one period does not carry over to another. Each period is assessed separately, including repeat visits to the same country.

Working from another country without approval may create a tax liability for both the employee and the company, and is treated as a conduct matter.

5 Equipment and Expenses

The company provides a laptop, a monitor, a keyboard and a mouse for home use. Employees may claim a one-off home office allowance towards a desk and chair, subject to the limit published by People Operations.

Equipment remains the property of the company and is returned on termination. Employees are responsible for keeping it secure and in working order.

Broadband and utility costs are not reimbursed. The detail of what may be claimed and how is outside this policy and is handled by an HR business partner.

6 Information Security

Work carried out remotely is subject to the same security requirements as work in the office. Company data is not stored on personal devices and is not accessed over public networks without the company virtual private network.

Employees working in a shared or public space take reasonable care that screens and conversations are not overlooked or overheard.

Loss of a device, or any suspected compromise of company data, is reported immediately and in any case within twenty-four hours.

7 Related Policies

Working hours and attendance are covered by HR-201. Flexible working, including a permanent contractual change to the place of work, is covered by HR-204.

8 Records

Remote and hybrid working arrangements are retained for three years from the date the arrangement ends.

9 Review

This policy is reviewed every two years, or earlier where legislation or business practice changes.